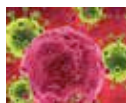
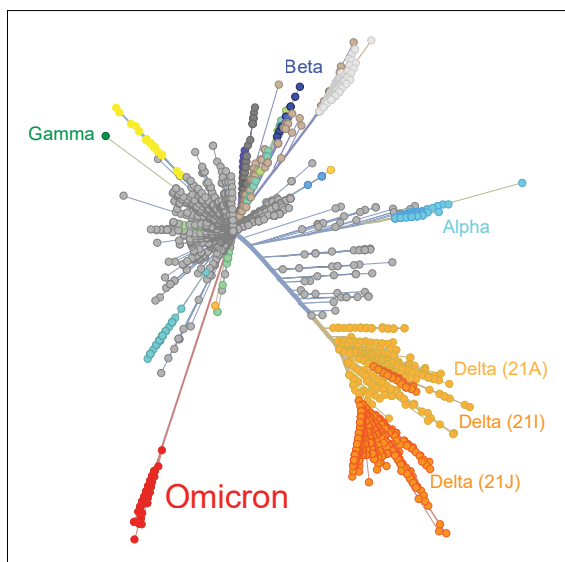




Single dose for all COVID variants
US Army about to create single vaccine
against all COVID & SARS variants
<https://dgit.in/jan22-49>



HIV prevention drug approved
The FDA approved first injectable
HIV prevention drug
<https://dgit.in/jan22-50>



Omicron branched out in early 2020

compared to the Delta variant. This does not mean, though, that we can take it lightly. At the end of the day, be it the Delta or the Omicron variant, once in a person's body, either variant can wreak havoc and cause severe health consequences.

From the numbers that are coming in each day from medical institutions and other statistical bodies across the world, it is evident that this variant has a much higher transmission rate than any other that we know of. It is to be noted that this is just a prediction of sorts. Despite the numbers on paper at the moment suggesting that this variant is transmitting rapidly, we would have to wait to know exactly what the situation is.

When it comes to the symptoms, the matter is as ambiguous as the previous aspects. There is no evidence suggesting that the variant has a different set of infection symptoms compared to the previous iterations. There's some bad news for the previously infected individuals. The reports that have come in at this early stage suggest that the people who had been previously infected by the Coronavirus, despite having recovered from the infection, are at a higher risk of being infected again. This time, by this moderately known variant called Omicron. Other vari-

ants of concern that are already out there, such as the Delta variant, has been known not to show such behaviour. It hasn't shown any sign of putting already infected people at a higher risk, but the Omicron indicates that trend.

THE DOS AND DON'TS

With the situation of the outbreak, especially concerning the Omicron variant evolving every passing second, as research

and infections continue, the best thing to do is prevent yourself from getting infected, because as they say, 'prevention is better than cure'.

If you are experiencing any symptoms of the infection, instead of waiting for them to reach a stage where they are severely affecting your health, get yourself tested. The RT-PCR and rapid antigen tests have so far been successful in detecting Omicron infections, so that's some good news. At least early diagnosis, followed by proper health care, will ensure that people are not that severely affected by the disease. It will also be better for the authorities to single patients out, making sure that proper precautions, isolation measures, and medications along with other aids are in order.

One of the most effective ways of protecting against getting infected and limiting the damage in case

of infection has been to get vaccinated. And, as far as initial research goes, the results are not that great to be looked at, but one thing is for sure that the damage inflicted on a person's body, potentially leading to death, can be limited by getting vaccinated. The vaccines that are available worldwide are effective enough to prevent severe infections against other variants too. So, if not Omicron, a vaccinated individual would be safe from infections that originate from other variants, at the least.

In terms of the medication, the more severely affected patients can be treated using Corticosteroids and IL6 Receptor Blockers. But, at the milder levels of infection, research is on to determine whether the current medicines will be effective against the virus or not.

WHAT ARE THE AUTHORITIES DOING?

Given the recency of this new variant and the complexity of the process of conducting any meaningful research, the world authorities have scrambled teams of brilliant minds to study this variant. The World Health Organisation, which has been effectively leading the way in our fight against the virus, has coordinated with researchers across the world to hasten the research process. But everything, especially in the field of science, dealing with such a sensitive issue, takes its due time, and so will this process.

While we await further information on the virus, we recommend you get vaccinated if you haven't already. Ensure that you properly wear good quality masks, ensure hand and overall personal hygiene, stay at least one metre away from others, and practice other related appropriate behaviour to keep yourself and others around you safe. Also, do keep an eye on these two portals to keep yourself updated with the latest developments related to the Omicron variant:

- <https://dgit.in/omi-info-1>
- <https://dgit.in/omi-info-2>



Stay put and stay safe